

evident and central. This is not recognized in municipalities, however, where the decisions are typically made.

Conclusion

This research highlights how societal structures and cultural practices can lead to randomness and thus contradiction in the preservation of built heritage. There seems to have been no shared understanding of the current state of built heritage and its challenges. Politically, the issues have not achieved a position where they would have been promoted in the long term. In the current public debate, the sustainability, quality, and cultural heritage of the built environment have hardly been discussed. Although the questions occasionally appear in the media, they have not yet entered the broader societal debate or any political agenda.

The remarkable change in the built environment in the 1960s and 1970s led to the development of our current legislation, which aimed to safeguard the country's built heritage. Now it seems that the demolition of buildings has again become more common. In different decades, political guidance has weakened the preservation of built heritage in the name of economic efficiency. This culture of demolition has long traditions in Finland, while challenging it has required public debate and the activity of citizens and authorities.

Museums are unable to solve the problem alone, but from a museological perspective, they do play a crucial role in societal debate. The research raises the question of whether museums contribute to discussions about the building preservation and the current state of built heritage. In the 1960s and 1970s, extensive demolitions forced preservation professionals to act and express their opinions. Since then, the institutional work in this field has significantly strengthened, but civil society continues to bear a large responsibility for public debate.

Museums are often involved in conflicts over built heritage. Although these conflicts may be local, they also have wider societal implications. It can be said that these debates are not only about protecting the built heritage but also about safeguarding democracy, which, in turn is based on an engaged civil society.

This research does not suggest that these contradictions arise everywhere. Exemplary preservation continues to take place, and some museums and other stakeholders have excellent practices. It is essential, however, to understand that as long as circumstances allow contradictions to persist or to weaken the current situation, randomness can threaten even the most exemplary of actions, especially if key personnel change.